Combat rule – Mounted combat · SRD 5.2.1

A rider can **mount** a **willing** creature that is at least **one size larger** and has a **suitable anatomy**. The rider can then **steer** it (controlled mount) or let it **act on its own** (independent mount).

🎲 Quick summary:

1. Mounting or dismounting: **half your Speed**.
2. **Controlled** mount: same initiative, Dash / Disengage / Dodge.
3. **Independent** mount: keeps its initiative.
4. Falling: **DC 10 Dexterity** save.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 keeps the 2014 rules and clarifies size, consent and falling.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say who is hit when a rider is attacked. Fix: the attacker chooses the target (rider or mount).

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the mount as a partner: it whinnies, rears, hesitates before danger.

Step 1 – Check:

Is the mount willing, one size larger and suitable?

Step 2 – Mount:

Spend **half your Speed** (rounded down).

Step 3 – Choose:

Controlled (trained) or **independent** mount.

Step 4 – Fight:

A controlled mount acts on your initiative; an independent one on its own.

Step 5 – Fall or dismount:

Dismounting also costs half your Speed. Make a DC 10 Dexterity save if the mount is moved against its will or if either of you is knocked Prone.

Example: Léa mounts her warhorse (25 ft of movement spent out of 50 ft). A shove pushes it away: she fails the DC 10 Dex save and lands Prone 5 ft away.

Aspect	Controlled mount	Independent mount
Initiative	The rider's	Its own
Actions	Dash, Disengage, Dodge	Mount's choice
Movement	Steered by the rider	By its own will
Training	Required	Not required
Examples	Warhorse, donkey	Dragon, unicorn, giant eagle

⚠ Common questions:

What size is needed?

One size larger than the rider.

How much does mounting cost?

Half your Speed.

What does a controlled mount do?

Dash, Disengage or Dodge.

And an independent mount?

It keeps its initiative and acts as it likes.

What save avoids a fall?

Dexterity DC 10.

Where do I land?

Prone, within 5 ft of the mount.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Controlled mount attacking

Can it attack? **Option**: no, unless war-trained.

Attack target

Rider or mount? **Option**: attacker's choice.

Intelligent mount

Does a dragon or unicorn always obey? **Option**: it stays independent.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Willing

A mount against its will can't serve.

Trained

A mount must be trained to be controlled.

Falling

The save also applies if the rider is knocked down.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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